Renouncers are homeless wanderers committed to celibacy. They possess only a saffron robe, begging bowl and staff. They are dedicated to liberation from rebirth through insight (***jnana-marga***) into the nature of the soul. The *Advaita-Vedantin* thinker ***Shankara***, himself a renouncer, thinks that the rituals and their results belong to the sphere of ignorance and desire and have no place in the life of the person who has realised that the soul is identical with the supreme reality beyond all difference and change.

Nevertheless, renunciation has always been controversial and for some people renouncers are objects of fear and suspicion. There is a resistance to the idea that anyone should abandon the rituals commanded by the ***Vedas*** and go it alone. So some traditions hold that ritual performance is mandatory: what one should renounce is desire for the results of the rituals.

Further reading: Dumont 1980; Olivelle 1986

Samsara: the unsatisfactory round of embodied existences propelled by the accumulated stock of merit and demerit (***karma***) associated with the soul (***atman***) and by which it is personalised. Release (***moksha***) from rebirth is the ultimate goal of all paths to salvation.

See ***Duhkha***

Samyoga (relation of conjunction): conjunction is classified by the ***Vaisheshikas*** as one of the sub-varieties of the category (***padartha***) quality (***guna***). This relation obtains only between individual substances (***dravya***). Direct conjunction, or contact between the surfaces of objects, is produced by some action. It is a separable relation, each case of which lasts as long as things are linked.

While the threads that have been woven to make a whole cloth are held together by inherence (***samavaya***), a heap of threads is related by conjunction.